

line,” says Himadri Das, Director General of International Management Institute (IMI).

Another key issue is the growing skills gap between academic training and industry requirements. Dhriti Prasanna Mahanta, Vice President and Business Head at TeamLease Degree Apprenticeship, says this mismatch is evident in the placement scenario at IITs, where the percentage of unplaced students has risen significantly.

Incidentally, almost all companies are investing, researching and exploring the impact of Gen AI. “This will significantly impact traditional job roles that management students typically pursue. Many of these roles will become redundant, while new job responsibilities will also emerge,” says BIMTECH’s Rajib.

WHAT DO COMPANIES WANT?

Hiring trends across industries are gradually shifting, leading to a demand for more technical and cross-functional skills over traditional qualifications like an MBA. Companies now hire individuals based on job description rather than educational background. “This shift is particularly evident in smart manufacturing, retail, logistics, and aviation sectors, where automation and AI have created a higher demand for engineers, IT specialists, data analysts, and supply chain experts,” says Mahanta.

“There is a shift in traditional marketing principles... MBA graduates specialising in marketing must now have a deep understanding of SEO, SEM, social media marketing, and other digital strategies,” says Rajesh Bharatiya, MD



“Almost all firms, big and small, are investing heavily in embracing Gen AI. This will have an impact on the traditional job roles... while new job responsibilities will emerge for students”

PRABINA RAJIB
DIRECTOR, BIRLA INSTITUTE OF
MANAGEMENT TECHNOLOGY (BIMTECH)



“We really need to change the mindset of students and faculty to understand that any educational institution, particularly a B-school, is at best the beginning of a transformation journey”

RAMAN RAMACHANDRAN
DIRECTOR & DEAN, K J SOMAIYA
INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT

of Peoplefy, a staffing company.

Das says companies prioritise the ability to apply knowledge. “With the pace of change today, there’s no longer the luxury of time to teach application skills.” The changes in hiring practices are about building a workforce that is agile, diverse, and capable of meeting the needs of a tech-driven world, says Mahanta.

In the financial services sector, there is a growing trend of hiring more engineers than MBAs. “This is due to the increasing need for skills in data analysis, risk management, and cybersecurity. Banks

are using big data to understand customer behaviour, develop new products, and manage risk,” says Deepak Malkani, Co-founder of consulting firm IndusGuru. “Recruiters are also turning to undergraduate colleges, seeking individuals with strong backgrounds in economics, psychology, and commerce,” says Rajib.

Experts suggest that B-schools need to understand the changing talent requirements. For instance, Kotak Mahindra Bank has created a senior-level post of ‘Chief of Customer Experience’. Similarly, IT firms such as Wipro